RYAN T. DOBSON

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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy: Evolutionary Psychology, Quantitative Methods Emphasis (Anticipated: May 2028)
The University of New Mexico (UNM), Albuquerque, NM
Advisor: Geoffrey Miller
Prospective Dissertation Focus:
My anticipated dissertation will examine the development of social and romantic bonds from an evolutionary perspective. Planned projects aim to integrate comparative hormone data—including over 20 years of longitudinal chimpanzee behavioral and endocrine data (in collaboration with Martin Muller)—with genetically informed human designs (adoption and twin data from the Minnesota Center for Twin and Family Research) to investigate intra- and inter-individual variation in social bonding and sexual behavior. This research aims to provide insight into the biological and developmental foundations of variation in social and sexual bonds.

Master of Science: Evolutionary Psychology (December 2024)
The University of New Mexico, Albuquerque, NM
Master's Thesis: Psychometric Exploration of the Five Love Languages
Conducted exploratory and confirmatory factor analyses to evaluate the latent structure and measurement validity of the Five Love Languages framework.

Bachelor of Science: Psychology, Philosophy minor (December 2022**)**
The University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire (UWEC), Eau Claire, WI
Honors Thesis: Jealousy in Opposite-Sex Friendships: The Threat of Being Replaced

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES

Dobson, R. T., Dinh, T., Reynolds, T. A., Emery Thompson, M., & Gangestad, S. W. (2026) Progesterone and negative emotionality across and between ovulatory cycles: A study of romantically involved women. *Hormones and Behavior.* https://doi.org/10.1016/j.yhbeh.2025.105860

Bleske-Rechek, A., **Dobson, R. T.**, Lay, P. S., Witthun, K. B., Johnson, W. N., & Bernstein, M. H. (2024) Women and men, harm and censoriousness: Sex-differentiated reactions to information about sex differences. *Journal of Open Inquiry in the Behavioral Sciences*. https:/doi.org/10.58408/issn.2992-9253.2024.02.04.0001

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW/REVISION

Dobson, R. T., Edwards, T., Giannelis, A., Miller, G. F., March, M. J., Willoughby, E. A., Krueger, R. F., Roisman, G. I., & McGue, M. Higher quality parent-child relationships predict lower-risk adolescent sexual behavior: A genetically informed sibling comparison. Invited revision at *Journal of Adolescent Health*

Vieth, G., **Dobson, R. T.,** Gangestad, S. W., & Simpson, J. A. Considering the evolutionary benefits and costs of friendship networks. Invited revision at *Evolution and Human Behavior*

Dobson, R. T., Costello, W., & Lewis, D. M.G. Men put their money where their mating motivations are: Mating interest predicts male financial investment in cross-sex friendships—and women detect it. Resubmitted minor revisions at *Evolution and Human Behavior*

Dobson, R. T., Dinh, T., Gangestad, S. W. Moderation of hormonal influences on women's extra-pair sexual interests by partner sexual attractiveness: Two preregistered studies. Under review at *Evolution and Human Behavior*

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Dinh, T., **Dobson, R. T.**, Emery Thompson, M., & Gangestad, S. W. Food, sex, and hormones: Evaluating functional explanations for hormonal influences on appetite. In preparation to be submitted to *Hormones and Behavior*

Hsiao, Y., & **Dobson, R. T.** A comparison of different approaches to correctly identifying partial factorial invariance: A Monte Carlo simulation. In preparation to be submitted to *Advances in Methods and Practices in Psychological Science*

INVITED CHAPTERS

Gangestad, S. W., **Dobson, R. T.**, & Simpson, J. A. Strategic Pluralism in Mating: Foundations and Critical Evaluation. Draft accepted for G. Geher, S. Karthikeyan, & A. C. Gallup (Eds.), *Oxford Handbook of Evolutionary Psychology*

PREREGISTRATIONS

Gangestad, S. W. & **Dobson, R. T.** (2025) A study examining associations of estimated estradiol and progesterone levels across the cycle with sexual interests in naturally cycling, partnered women. https://osf.io/zyv5w

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Institute of Mental Chronometry
Graduate Student Travel Award, 2025 – $1,000.00
For presentation at the International Society for Intelligence Research annual research conference

University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire Office of Research and Sponsored Programs
Summer Research Grant, 2022 – $1200.00
Student research supervised by Dr. April Bleske-Rechek

The University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire Office of Research and Sponsored Programs
Student Travel Award, 2022 – $650.00

VISTING RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

University of Minnesota – Minnesota Center for Twin and Family Research
Visiting Graduate Researcher (Behavior Genetics)
Fall 2025 – Spring 2026
Primary Mentor: Matt McGue, Ph.D.
Conducting genetically informed analyses using adoption and twin datasets to examine parent-child relationship quality and adolescent sexual behavior. Training in quantitative behavior genetic modeling and within-family analytic designs.

Murdoch University (Perth, Australia)
Visiting Graduate Researcher, Evolution and Social Cognition Lab
January 2026
Host: David M.G. Lewis, Ph.D.
Collaborative research on evolutionary models of same- and cross-sex friendship.

PROFESSIONAL CONFERENCE POSTERS & PRESENTATIONS

Dobson, R. T., Edwards, T., Giannelis, A., Miller, G. F., March, M. J., Willoughby, E. A., Gangestad, S. W., Krueger, R. F., Roisman, G. I., & McGue, M. (2026, May) Better relationships with parents make children less promiscuous: Evidence for developmental calibration of sexual strategies from a genetically informed

adoption study of 617 families. *Talk to be presented at the 37th Human Behavior and Evolution Society conference, Rabat, Morocco*

Dobson, R. T., Dinh, T., & Gangestad, S. W. (2026, April) Moderation of hormonal influences on women's extra-pair sexual interests by partner sexual attractiveness: Two preregistered studies. *Talk to be presented at the 20th annual Northeastern Evolutionary Psychology Society conference, Pittsburgh, PA*

Gangestad, S. W., & **Dobson, R. T.** (2026, April) Men's possessiveness of romantic partners across their ovarian cycles: A preregistered study. *Talk to be presented at the 20th annual Northeastern Evolutionary Psychology Society conference, Pittsburgh, PA*

Dobson, R. T., & Edwards, T. (2025, July) Specific cognitive abilities predict socio-political attitudes above and beyond *g*. *Poster presented at the 25th annual International Society for Intelligence Research conference, Evanston, IL*

Gangestad, S. W., Dinh, T., & **Dobson, R. T.** (2025, June) Food, sex, and hormones: Assessing trade-offs between appetite and sexual interests. *Talk presented at the 19th annual Northeastern Evolutionary Psychology Society conference, Atlantic City, NJ*

Dobson, R. T., Lewis, D. M.G., & Miller, G. F. (2025, June) Friends, lovers, or something in between? Variability in opposite-sex friendships. *Talk presented at the 19th annual Northeastern Evolutionary Psychology Society conference, Atlantic City, NJ*

Poe, M., Reynolds, T. A., **Dobson, R. T.**, Costello, W., & Thomas, A. (2025, June) Examining predictors of cross-sex distrust and antipathy. *Poster presented at the 36th annual Human Behavior & Evolution Society conference, Atlantic City, NJ*

Gangestad, S. W., Dinh, T., & **Dobson, R. T.** (2025, June) Ovarian hormones moderate associations of women's loving attachment to partners with in-pair vs. extra-pair sexual interests. *Talk presented at the 36th annual Human Behavior & Evolution Society conference, Atlantic City, NJ*

Costello, W., **Dobson, R. T.**, & Lewis, D. M.G. (2025, June) Opposite sex friendships: Men (but not women) put their money where their mating motivations are. *Talk presented at the 36th annual Human Behavior & Evolution Society conference, Atlantic City, NJ*

***Dobson, R. T.,** Dinh, T., Reynolds, T. A., Emery Thompson, M., & Gangestad, S. W. (2025, June) Progesterone and negative emotionality across and between ovulatory cycles: A study of romantically involved women. *Talk presented at the 36th annual Human Behavior & Evolution Society conference, Atlantic City, NJ*

*****Talk was submitted alongside completed manuscript and was 1 one of 4 papers selected from over 40 papers as a finalist for the New Investigator Award.

Dobson, R. T., Lewis, D. M.G., & Miller, G. F. (2025 February) How many 'love languages' are there, really? *Poster presented at the 25th annual Society for Personality and Social Psychology conference, Denver, CO*

Dobson, R. T., Dinh, T., Reynolds, T. A., Emery Thompson, M., & Gangestad, S. W. (February 2025) Progesterone and negative emotionality across and between ovulatory cycles: A study of romantically involved women. *Data blitz presented at the Evolutionary Preconference of the 25th annual Society for Personality and Social Psychology conference, Denver, CO*

Dobson, R. T., Aella, & Miller, G. F., (2024, May) The evolutionary psychology of BDSM: Insights from a factor-analytic study of 136 sexual kinks in 33,668 adults. *Poster presented at the 35th annual Human Behavior & Evolution Society conference, Aarhus, Denmark*

Dobson, R. T., Bleske-Rechek, A., Lay, P., Witthun, K., Johnson, W., & Bernstein, M. H. (2024, May) Women and men, harm and censoriousness: Sex-differentiated reactions to information about

sex differences *Poster presented at the 35th annual Human Behavior & Evolution Society conference, Aarhus, Denmark*

Bleske-Rechek, A., Bernstein, M. H., **Dobson, R. T.**, Lay, P., Johnson, W., & Witthun, K. (2024, April) Women and men, harm and censoriousness: Sex-differentiated reactions to information about sex differences *Talk presented at the 18th annual Northeastern Evolutionary Psychology Society conference, Niagara Falls, NY*

Lay, P., **Dobson, R.**, Witthun, K., Johnson. W., Bernstein, M., & Bleske-Rechek, A. (2023, April) Race predicts reactions to controversial information about racism in policing. *Poster presented at the National Conference on Undergraduate Research, Eau Claire, WI*

Dobson, R. (2022, December) Jealousy in opposite-sex friendships: The threat of being replaced. *Talk given at the semi-annual Honors Thesis Presentation Session hosted by the University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire, Eau Claire, WI*

Dobson, R., Johnson, W., & Witthun, K. (2022, April) Reactions to controversial information as a function of messenger identity: Racism in Policing. *Talk given at the 12th annual Provost Honors Symposium hosted by the University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire, Eau Claire, WI*

Witthun, K., **Dobson, R**., Johnson, W., Bleske-Rechek, A., & Bernstein, M. (2022, April) Does lived experience trump medical expertise? Factors that predict reactions to controversial information about antidepressants. *Poster presented at the 16th annual Northeastern Evolutionary Psychology Society conference, Pittsburgh, PA*

Dobson, R., Johnson, W., Witthun, K., Bernstein M., & Bleske-Rechek. A. (2022, April) Reactions to controversial information about racism in policing as a function of messenger identity and news platform. *Poster presented at the 16th annual Northeastern Evolutionary Psychology Society conference, Pittsburgh, PA*

Lay, P., **Dobson, R.**, Witthun, K., Johnson, W., Bernstein M., & Bleske-Rechek, A. (2022, April) Effects of messenger gender identity on men's and women's reactions to information about evolved differences between the sexes. *Poster presented at the 16th annual Northeastern Evolutionary Psychology Society conference, Pittsburgh, PA*

Witthun, K., Lay, P., **Dobson, R**., Johnson, W., Bleske-Rechek, A., & Bernstein, M. (2022, April) Who has credibility? Effects of messenger cis/trans identity on reactions to controversial information about gender dysphoria. *Poster presented at the 16th annual Northeastern Evolutionary Psychology Society conference, Pittsburgh, PA*

Bleske-Rechek, A., Lay, P., **Dobson, R**., & Witthun, K. (2021, May) Shoot the messenger: changes in evaluations of scientific information as a function of messenger identity. *Poster presented at the 33rd annual convention of the Association for Psychological Science (virtual).*

INVITED TALKS AND GUEST LECTURES

Dobson, R. T., Dinh, T., & Gangestad, S. W. (2026, February) Moderation of hormonal influences on women's extra-pair sexual interests by partner sexual attractiveness: Two preregistered studies. *Guest presentation at the University of Melbourne psychology department hosted by Khandis Blake's Evolution Lab, Melbourne, Australia*

Dobson, R. T. (2026, January) Cross-sex friendships: A comparative perspective and agenda for future research. *Guest presentation at David M.G. Lewis's Evolution and Social Cognition research lab at Murdoch University, Perth, Australia*

Dobson, R. T. (2025, September) Empirical test of the Five Love Languages. *Guest lecture in Geoffrey Miller's Human Sexuality course at the University of New Mexico, Albuquerque, NM*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of New Mexico

Instructor of Record – Statistical Principles (Online), Summer 2025

Laboratory Instructor – Advanced Statistics (Graduate Core Course), 2025

RESEARCH DATA MANAGEMENT & PREPARATION

Kibale Chimpanzee Project (Supervised by Co-Director, Martin Muller, Ph.D.)
University of New Mexico, 2026-Present
Helped manage intensive longitudinal data of Chimpanzees across 20+ years of behavioral observations.

Relationship Dynamics: Endocrinology and Behavior (NSF funded; PI: Steven Gangestad, Ph.D.; Co-PI: Melissa Emery Thompson, Ph.D)
University of New Mexico, 2024-2025
Developed transparent and reproducible data preprocessing workflows in R and Python for three intensive longitudinal studies tracking endocrine and behavioral dynamics across the menstrual cycle.

ABQ Treat Clinical Research Project (NIH-funded; Co-PIs: Barbara McCrady, Ph.D., Katie Witkiewitz, Ph.D., & Eric Claus, Ph.D.)
University of New Mexico, 2024
Developed reproducible, version-controlled data-cleaning variable harmonization, and quality-control pipelines in R and GitHub for a large longitudinal clinical trial dataset.

AD HOC PEER REVIEWS

Evolution and Human Behavior

Personality and Individual Differences

SPECIALIZED TRAINING & METHODS WORKSHOPS

International Statistical Genetics Workshop – Institute for Behavior Genetics (8-day virtual intensive), June, 2026

Longitudinal Structural Equation Modeling – CenterStat (5-day intensive), 2026

Introduction to Agent-Based Modeling – Santa Fe Institute (9-week open online course), 2025

Causal Inference for Multilevel Data – Statistical Horizons (1-day workshop), 2025

Sample Size Justification – Statistical Horizons (3-day intensive), 2025

Modern Missing Data Analysis – CenterStat (3-day intensive), 2024

Multilevel Models for Longitudinal Data – CenterStat (4-day intensive), 2024

Multilevel Models for Hierarchical Data – CenterStat (3-day intensive), 2024

Introduction to Structural Equation Modeling – CenterStat (3-day intensive), 2024

Artificial Intelligence: Implications for Business Strategy – MIT Sloan (1-month online course), 2019

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Behavioral Genetic Association

International Society for Intelligence Research

Society for Personality and Social Psychology

Human Behavior & Evolution Society

Northeastern Evolutionary Psychology Society

STUDENT/FACULTY COLLABORATIVE READING GROUPS

Readings in Philosophy of Science

Founder and Co-Organizer; bi-weekly graduate/faculty seminar (Faculty advisors: Steven Gangestad, UNM; Duygu Uygun Tunc, University of Chicago), Fall 2025 – Spring 2026

Readings in Behavior Genetics and Individual Differences

Participated in weekly seminar led by Matt McGue, University of Minnesota, Spring 2025; Fall 2025 – Spring 2026

Readings in Evolutionary Psychology & Individual Differences

Participated in weekly research lab discussions led by April Bleske-Rechek, University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire, Fall 2021 – Spring 2022